of the ENPO and take matters forward. This he did and the ENPO officially revoked its non-cooperation movement on 28 April 2022, just a few days before I retired. The Inquiry itself was completed in record time and directions were given on it by Lt Gen Pande in his capacity of Eastern Army Commander for administrative and disciplinary action at various levels in the chain of command. The aim was not to 'punish' anyone but to ensure that such heartbreaking incidents do not recur. It also showed that differences can be resolved through dialogue and a sympathetic approach.

In the months that followed, the AR carried out a number of civic action projects to regain the trust and confidence of the locals. This effort has yielded results, so much so that the local population has even offered their land for establishing a temporary AR camp in Oting itself, quite close to 'ground zero', the site where the unfortunate incident occurred.

## Litigation

One often hears or sees news reports of serving or retired personnel going to Court to seek redress of grievances. This is perfectly fine and within their rights. In many instances, the Courts rule in favour of the individual, which is also fine by us. However, the problem arises in the implementation of the Court order, which can only be done after MoD approval. At times, even if the Army has accepted the ruling of the Court, the Ministry may decide to appeal. A case in point is the One Rank One Pension (OROP) scheme. Without going into the merits of specific cases, the fact is that once a decision has been given, it should be implemented, instead of giving specious excuses. All possible rulings, favourable or unfavourable, should have been anticipated and catered for.

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